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Winnebago

Author:

Elijah Sams & Brian Sams

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Winnebago
by Elijah Sams and Brian Sams

Dad: Oh, jeez, kids, this is gonna be great! Get your bags and books and head out to the Winnebago! Woohoo!

Tommy: Where are we going this time, Dad?

Dad: It's going to be quite a ride, Tommy. The Washington Monument, the Statue of Liberty and then....

Jefferson: How many days should I pack for, Dad?

Dad: Two, Jeffy, we'll just be gone for the weekend! Jack?

Jack: What?

Dad: Get your stuff, buddy.

Jack: No. No way, Dad. These road trips are the worst.

Dad: Sorry, Jack old boy! The Winnebago waits for no man!

Jack: The Winnebago waits for every man, Dad. Even when it's running you can catch up to it without breathing hard.

Dad: Tommy, Jefferson? Ready? (Putting on seat belt.) Jack, just one last trip. Alright kids...Winnebago! Winnebago! Winnebago! (Turns key, acts like it starts.) Yes! We're off! (Sings Born to be Wild by Steppenwolf.)

Intro: Road trips. You either love em or hate em, but most often what makes the difference is the people you who are along with you for the ride. Winnebago.

Dad: Aw, jeez kids, would you look at that! The Washington Monument! What a sight! How tall, Tommy?

Tommy: Ummm, 555 feet 5 and 1/8 inches, Dad!

Dad: Wowzers! When was it built?...Okay, Jefferson!

Jefferson: Construction began in 1848, but wasn't completed until 1888.

Jack: About like when you remodeled the bathroom, Dad.

Dad: Haha, Jack. (Turns off key, puts it in Park.) Alright, let's get the tour!

(Exits the Winnebago)

Dad: Huh, that's weird. No tour guides. Looks like we have the place to ourselves again!

Jefferson: Dad, you be the tour guide!

Dad: Alright, let's see. Welcome to the Washington Monument! Built to commemorate George Washington, this tower...

Jack: Obelisk, Dad. It's an obelisk. It has four sides and it tapers to the top. It's an obelisk.

Dad: Thank you, Jack. As I was saying... This tower---ing obelisk is 555 feet tall and was completed in 1888. It took so long to complete because the hardware store is a long ways away and you don't always have the right fittings for the shower...

Tommy: The book says it took a long time because of a lack of funds.

Dad: Well, I can believe in that, Tommy! Jefferson, what else can you tell us about this towering basilisk?

Jefferson: Obelisk, Daddy! Well, when it was completed, it was the tallest building in the world, beating out the Cologne Cathedral, until the Eiffel Tower was built in 1889, in Paris, France.

Dad: Darn those French! What an insult! I'm pretty sure there's nothing they could do to make up for that! Oh, no wait, French Fries!

Jack: Not actually French. Probably Belgian.

Dad: See, there you go! French culinary oppression! Come see the violence inherent in the system! Did you kids read everything? Good. Off to the Statue of Liberty! I want you to draw a picture of the monument for Mommy and read up on the Statue! It's a four hour drive, so grab a sandwich, finish your reading, and take a nap! Lotsa room in the Winnebago! Winnebago! Winnebago! Winnebago! (Turns key and it “starts”) Woohoo!

(Singing Life is a Highway)

Jack: Dad, how long is this going to take?

Dad: Grab a sandwich, Jack! This is the whole weekend!

Jack: I can see that you're teaching the boys a lot, Dad, but why am I here?

Dad: Hey, buddy, a couple months and bam, you're off to college. Full ride scholarship, though! Why's that?

Jack: Because you made me study on our road trips.

Dad: And...?

Jack: And we haven't got a dime thanks to all the medical bills...

Dad: C'mon Jack, none of that! And...

Jack: And instilled a natural curiosity and love of learning... College entrance essay #2.

Dad: So just humor your old dad, and enjoy the trip.

Jack: Oh, it's a trip alright.

Dad: Ah, you'll soon find yourself loving it, Jack! You always do! Winnebago! Winnebago! Winnebago! Yes!

Transition - Country Roads -

Dad: Tommy, Jefferson! Wake up! There she is! The Statue of Liberty! Gosh, what a beaut! Got your shoes on? Fantastic! Out we go! Whattya say we find ourselves an authentic New York tour guide?

Tommy: I don't know, Dad, I don't see any tour guides.

Jefferson: Neither do I!

Jack: Amazing. Eight and half million people and no tour guides.

Dad: Yeah, Jack, you'd think there'd be an unemployed comedian looking for work...

Tommy: Do it, Dad! Be the tour guide!

Dad: (Now in a New York accent, strong, but poorly done.) Awright, 'spose you two utes could tell me what it is that we're looking at right over here?

Jefferson: The Statue of Liberty!

Dad: Uh huh, uh huh, dat's correct, hows about some particulars?

Tommy: She's was a gift from France, and it's pretty neat that she was built by Gustav Eiffel, the man that beat the Washington Monument for tallest building.

Dad: Them Frenchies will surprise you, eh? Now, whose can tells me how much green paint it takes to paint milady each and every year? Tommy? Jefferson? Bueller? Bueller? Hey, you lookin' at me?

Jack: Not really.

Dad: You lookin at me? You lookin at me? I'm tour guidin' here! I'm tour guidin' here! So, how much paint, smart guy?

Jack: None. Is that supposed to be DeNiro? That's terrible. Originally, it would have been a bright copper color, but over time it developed the green patina...

Dad: Yeah, yeah, yeah. Smarty pants, farty pants. Tommy, Jefferson, hows about chu elucidate Alfred Einstein here about what this fantastical sculpture represents?

Jefferson: According to the articles you gave us, Dad...

Dad: Eh! Oh! Oh! Eh!

Jefferson: Oops, sorry random, aggressive, New York tour guide, there are several symbols used. On her book is written, July 4, 1776, and by her feet there are broken chains.

Tommy: And her torch is supposed to symbolize freedom. The real name of the Statue is Liberty Enlightening the World.

Dad: Jeez, you kids are so smart! Won't your mom be so proud! Back in the ol' RV, bust out your no. 2s and Crayolas and get to work! Give me your tired, your poor, your huddled masses yearning to breathe free, the wretched refuse of your teeming shore! Something, something, something...

Jack: Send these, the homeless, tempest tossed, to me, I lift my lamp beside the golden door. Speaking of homeless, how long until we move into this thing full time?

Dad: Hey! Not in front of the kids! Alright, everyone set? Juice boxes ready? Hand one to me...no, don't squeeze it.... ah, no that's okay, happens to the best of us. You can read up on hydraulics, Tommy, we've got a long drive, an overnighter! Winnebago, Winnebago, Winnebago! Yes! Grand Canyon, here we come!

Jack: I'm not staying in the Winnebago overnight, Dad.

Dad: C'mon. It's a family road trip! Where else are you gonna go?

Jack: I'm going to open this door, step out onto the lawn, walk across the yard and back into our house.

Dad: Jack, you'll ruin it for the kids!

Jack: Dad, I'm seventeen! I can't play kid's games anymore.

Dad: Your mother doesn't want you in there right now.

Jack: Are you serious? You're out here playing games with Tommy and Jefferson and who's helping Mom get to the bathroom? Or don't you care?

Dad: She's meeting with a hospice nurse.

Jack: What? Hospice is for people that are dying. Mom's just sick… Mom's just sick, right?

Dad: She's stopping certain meds and starting some others that will make things... easier.. Mom didn't want you guys there tonight, it might not be... very pleasant. Tomorrow. After the Grand Canyon.

Jack: Holy crap, Dad! Mom's dying and you've got us trapped in a broken down Winnebago playing road trip again!

Dad: What do you want me to do, Jack? She asked me to. One last road trip, with pictures from the little boys and me to try to break this to you... which I guess I didn't do a very good job. I'm sorry. We never really had the time or the money to take you anyplace for real. Just this. I thought I'd get it fixed someday and...

Jack: Dad. Check out the sunset!

Dad: It's nice, Jack. It's a nice sunset.

Jack: It's more than a nice sunset! It's a Grand Canyon Sunset!

Dad: It's a 34 hour drive to Arizona, Jack. The boys expect a certain amount of realism...

Jack: It's the Grand Canyon, Dad.

Dad: Okay... Great news, kids! We're already at the Grand Canyon! And just in time for sunset! Too late for tour guides, I'm afraid. Everyone out!

Dad: Great Scot! You were right Jack, that's one heckuva sunset.

Tommy: Wow. Thanks for taking us to the Grand Canyon, Dad.

Jefferson: Yeah. Wait until I tell Mom about this view.

Jack: Hey, Dad, you're doing a great job, but we should take the kids to Italy sometime. Rome. Pompeii, Mount Vesuvius and all that.

Dad: Jack, you know we can't afford that, there's not going to be any life insurance, if that's what you're...

Jack: No, Dad, I meant, we could take the Winnebago.

Dad: Oh. I see. Hey, kids! Can you believe that this here canyon was just made by Paul Bunyan dragging his axe?

Jack: Just...just enjoy the moment, Dad.